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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

SATURDAY, 31 OCTOBER 2026

16 must-know stories, 24 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 14 explainers, picked from 807 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Union Cabinet approves amendments to anti-paper leak law

The Union Cabinet approved amendments to the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024. The decision was taken amid nationwide protests over the NEET examination paper leak and student demands for accountability. During the briefing, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwani Vaishnaw declined to answer queries regarding fast-track courts and strict actions. Representatives of the Cockroach Janata Party met Union Ministers J.P. Nadda and Dr. Jitendra Singh to discuss agitation demands. The Cockroach Janata Party put forward three main demands and five suggestions for examination reforms during the meeting. Union Minister J.P. Nadda stated that the government will hold internal discussions and meet the CJP representatives again the next afternoon.

When: 2026-10-31 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Ashwani Vaishnaw, J.P. Nadda, Dr. Jitendra Singh, Cockroach Janata Party · **Prelims:** The act amended is the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024.; Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwani Vaishnaw briefed the media on the cabinet decisions.; Cockroach Janata Party representatives met Union Ministers J.P. Nadda and Dr. Jitendra Singh.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights legislative responses to systemic vulnerabilities in India's public examination system.; Demonstrates the government's engagement with protesting groups and political parties regarding examination reforms.*

Static — The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act aims to curb malpractices and organized cheating in public examinations in India. Union Cabinet decisions are taken collectively by the Prime Minister and senior cabinet ministers under the executive framework of governance. Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions handles administrative matters related to personnel policy and public examinations.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Census 2027 population enumeration phase to be of record 50 days

The population enumeration phase of Census 2027 will last for a record 50 days from January 10 to February 28, which includes a 15-day self-enumeration window. This duration is significantly longer than the conventional 20-day Phase-2 duration of past census exercises like the 2011 census. The extended timeline is linked to the increased number of questions, totaling 40 items compared to 29 in 2011, which now includes caste data. The nationwide census notification issued by the Union home ministry sets the main population enumeration from January 25 to February 27, 2027. Exemptions and schedule variations apply to Manipur, poll-bound states like Goa, UP, Punjab, and Uttarakhand, as well as Ladakh and snow-bound areas of Himachal Pradesh and J&K. New fields being captured in Phase-2 include caste, spouse name, parents' particulars, declared nationality, permanent address, Covid-19 vaccination place, and various identification numbers like Aadhaar and voter ID. The reference date for Census 2027 is declared as March 1, 2027, and will be followed by a revisional round from March 1 to March 5, 2027.

When: January 10 to February 28, 2027 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Home Ministry · **Prelims:** The reference date for Census 2027 is March 1, 2027.; Phase-2 of Census 2027 will include 40 questions, up from 29 in 2011.; The self-enumeration window is scheduled from January 10 to January 24, 2027.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for updating national demographic statistics and socio-economic planning.; Inclusion of expanded data points like caste and digital identifiers provides deeper insights for governance and welfare targeting.*

Static — The Census in India is conducted under the Census Act of 1948, providing the legal framework for carrying out decennial population censuses. It is conducted by the Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, India, operating under the Ministry of Home Affairs.

The decennial census is one of the largest administrative and statistical exercises in the world, collecting comprehensive demographic, social, and economic data.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy, Society · Prelims angle: Report/Index

Times of India: read the source · also reported by Imphal Times, Indian Express

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Quad Leaders' Summit to take place in Manila next month, says US Secy of State Marco Rubio

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio announced that the next Quad Leaders Summit will take place in Manila, Philippines, next month. The summit is expected to occur on the sidelines of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations meetings in November. This announcement follows a meeting of Quad foreign ministers in Atlanta on October 31 involving representatives from India, the US, Japan, and Australia. The Atlanta meeting marked the third gathering of Quad foreign ministers this year, following meetings in New Delhi in May and Manila in July. Ministers discussed enhancing cooperation in critical areas such as reliable supply chains, emerging technologies, maritime security, and critical minerals. The upcoming Manila gathering marks the first leaders meeting since September 2024, when the previous summit was hosted in Wilmington, Delaware. India was originally expected to host the summit in 2025, but it did not materialise due to scheduling difficulties and uncertainties. The upcoming summit serves to revive high-level political momentum within the four-country Indo-Pacific grouping.

When: November 2026 · **Where:** Manila, Philippines · **Who:** Marco Rubio, S. Jaishankar, Penny Wong, Toshimitsu Motegi · **Prelims:** The Quad foreign ministers met in Atlanta on October 31.; The last Quad Leaders Summit was held in September 2024 in Wilmington, Delaware.; Foreign ministers who attended the Atlanta meeting include S. Jaishankar, Marco Rubio, Penny Wong, and Toshimitsu Motegi.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It revives high-level political momentum for the Quad after a gap since September 2024.; It reinforces diplomatic and strategic cooperation among India, the US, Japan, and Australia in the Indo-Pacific.*

Static — The Quadrilateral Security Dialogue, or Quad, is an informal strategic forum comprising India, the United States, Japan, and Australia. The grouping traces its origins back to the 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami core group and was first proposed formally in 2007. The Quad was revived in 2017 at the level of officials and elevated to ministerial and leaders summits in subsequent years.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by Ministry of External Affairs, Telangana Today, The Hindu, NDTV, The Economic Times, Economic Times, New India Abroad, Internazionale, Firstpost, News18

GS2 MAKE NOTES

PM Modi Extends Best Wishes to China for BRICS Presidency, Reviews India-China Ties with Xi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on Saturday. PM Modi conveyed his best wishes to President Xi for China's upcoming BRICS Presidency commencing next year. The leaders reviewed the full range of India-China relations and welcomed steady progress since their meeting in Tianjin in August 2025. PM Modi emphasized that bilateral relations should be guided by three mutuals: mutual respect, mutual sensitivity, and mutual interest. Modi stressed that peace and tranquillity in border areas remain essential, and both sides must adhere to existing border agreements. Both leaders committed to a fair, reasonable, and mutually acceptable resolution of the boundary question. The leaders underlined the need to address structural trade imbalances, supply chain issues, and facilitate predictable market access. PM Modi announced the adoption of the New Delhi Declaration by consensus at the end of the opening day of the BRICS Summit.

When: 2026-10-31 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping · **Prelims:** The 18th BRICS Summit was hosted by India at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.; India's BRICS Chairship theme was Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.; The previous meeting between PM Modi and President Xi took place in Tianjin in August 2025.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights diplomatic engagement at the highest level between India and China to manage differences and maintain border peace.; Addresses critical economic concerns including structural trade imbalances and supply chain issues between the two nations.*

Static — BRICS is an informal grouping of major emerging economies comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, later expanded to include new members. The acronym BRIC was coined by Jim O'Neill in 2001, and the first BRIC summit took place in Yekaterinburg, Russia, in 2009. South Africa joined the grouping in December 2010, transforming it from BRIC to BRICS.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

BRICS 2026: Lavrov, Manturov Arrive in New Delhi Ahead of Summit

Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov and First Deputy Prime Minister Denis Manturov arrived in New Delhi for the 18th BRICS Summit. Russian President Vladimir Putin arrived earlier for a working visit to India as BRICS marks 20 years since its establishment. President Putin will address the BRICS Business Forum plenary session on September 11 and hold bilateral talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi. PM Modi and President Putin are scheduled to visit the INNOPROM exhibition, organized by the industry and trade ministries of India and Russia. Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) President Zou Jiayi also arrived in New Delhi to attend the summit. MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal noted that Zou Jiayi's visit will strengthen partnerships for sustainable development and emerging economies. India is hosting the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12 and 13 under its chairship for 2026. India's 2026 BRICS chairship theme is Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability, focusing on development and innovation.

When: September 12-13, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Sergey Lavrov, Denis Manturov, Vladimir Putin, Narendra Modi, Zou Jiayi, Randhir Jaiswal · **Prelims:** India is hosting the 18th BRICS Summit on September 12-13, 2026.; The theme for India's BRICS chairship is Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.; Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) is headquartered in Beijing and began operations in 2016.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's diplomatic leadership and chairship of the major multilateral grouping BRICS in 2026.; Deepens strategic and bilateral ties between India and Russia through high-level visits and joint events like INNOPROM.*

Static — BRICS is an intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, later expanded to include new member nations. The grouping was originally formed as BRIC in 2006 before South Africa joined in 2010, making it BRICS. The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) is a multilateral development bank focused on financing infrastructure in Asia, which began operations in 2016.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, Australia unveil new defence and security partnership, commit to deeper strategic cooperation in Indo-Pacific

India and Australia unveiled a new Joint Declaration on Defence and Security Cooperation during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Australia. The declaration was adopted by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese to deepen strategic collaboration. The agreement builds on the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership established in 2020 and the 2009 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation. Both nations expressed concern over growing geostrategic uncertainty and called for peaceful dispute resolution in accordance with international law. The leaders underscored the importance of respecting sovereignty, territorial integrity, and freedom of navigation under UNCLOS 1982. The partnership outlines enhanced defence cooperation, including increased military exercise complexity, information sharing, and aircraft deployments. A dedicated India-Australia Maritime Security Collaboration Roadmap was announced to strengthen maritime engagement and domain awareness. Both countries committed to resilient supply chains, critical minerals cooperation, clean energy technologies, and cyber security under Australia-India PACTS.

When: 2026-10-31 · **Where:** Australia · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese · **Prelims:** The Comprehensive Strategic Partnership between India and Australia was established in 2020.; The India-Australia Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation was originally signed in 2009.; The Migration and Mobility Partnership Arrangement was signed in 2023.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens bilateral defence interoperability and maritime security architecture in the Indo-Pacific region.; Deepens cooperation in critical technologies, supply chain resilience, and critical minerals essential for future economic security.*

Static — India and Australia established a Bilateral Security Dialogue in 2009, which was upgraded to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2020 during a virtual leaders' summit. The Quad grouping comprises India, Australia, Japan, and the United States, cooperating to ensure a free, open, and inclusive Indo-Pacific region. UNCLOS (United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea) of 1982 is the international framework that defines the rights and responsibilities of nations in maritime and ocean spaces.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Defence

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by DD News

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Government of India extends Customs Duty Exemption on Cotton imports up to 31st December 2026

The central government has extended the customs duty exemption on cotton imports by two months until December 31, 2026. The decision aims to increase the availability of cotton for the domestic textile sector and improve market supply. In May, an earlier five-month exemption was introduced, which was originally scheduled to expire on October 31, 2026. The finance ministry stated the extension will help reduce input costs across the textile and apparel manufacturing sector. It is designed to provide targeted relief to both manufacturers and consumers while keeping domestic farmers' interests in mind. The measure is expected to positively impact domestic textile industry performance, particularly small and medium enterprises. Better availability of raw cotton in the market will ease production pressures for domestic players.

When: December 31, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Finance Ministry · **Prelims:** The customs duty exemption on cotton imports was extended till December 31, 2026.; The initial exemption announced in May lasted for five months.; The extension period announced is two months.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps reduce input costs for domestic textile and apparel manufacturers.; Provides relief to small and medium enterprises by ensuring better raw material availability.*

Static — Customs duty is a tax levied on goods imported into India, regulated under the Customs Act of 1962. The Union Ministry of Finance holds the power to grant exemptions from customs duties under Section 25(1) of the Customs Act, 1962, in public interest. The Indian textile and apparel sector is one of the largest employers and contributors to India's export earnings.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on ptinews.com*

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Poverty Reduction in India – World Bank Report 2026

The World Bank Poverty and Equity Brief reported India's extreme poverty rate declined sharply to 2.6% in 2023 from 27.1% in 2011. The decline was driven by robust household consumption growth, extensive expansion in employment, higher female workforce participation, and targeted government social welfare transfers. Despite rapid monetary poverty reduction, substantial structural challenges persist around deep wage disparities, stagnant real earnings, low-productivity jobs, and rising youth unemployment. Between 2011 and 2023, the population living below the lower-middle-income poverty threshold of 4.20 dollars per day fell from 57.7% to 16.1%. This shift represents roughly 496 million individuals lifting themselves above the 4.20 dollars per day lower-middle-income poverty threshold over the twelve-year period. Employment expanded by around 13.4 crore between 2017 and 2023, largely fueled by rural women entering the paid labor force. In 2023, median earnings for the top 10% of workers were approximately 13 times higher than those of the bottom 10%. Poverty has become heavily concentrated geographically, with around 57% of India's poor residing in a contiguous belt spanning from Uttar Pradesh to West Bengal.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** India (specifically Uttar Pradesh to West Bengal belt) · **Who:** The World Bank · **Prelims:** India's extreme poverty rate dropped from 27.1% in 2011 to 2.6% in 2023.; Population below the $4.20/day line declined from 57.7% in 2011 to 16.1% in 2023.; 57% of India's poor live in a contiguous belt from Uttar Pradesh to West Bengal.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Validates the impact of large-scale social welfare programmes, food subsidies, and rural female job creation over the past decade.; Underlines that policy must now pivot from basic poverty alleviation to generating high-productivity jobs and reducing regional disparities.*

Static — Poverty estimation in independent India was traditionally based on minimum nutritional intake requirements, recommended by planning groups such as the Alagh Committee (1979) and Lakdawala Committee (1993). The Tendulkar Committee (2009) shifted poverty estimation from calorie intake to uniform private household consumption expenditure across rural and urban areas, covering health and education. The Rangarajan Committee (2014) revised methodology using an independent basket of goods, estimating poverty lines at 32 rupees for rural areas and 47 rupees for urban areas per day.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Social Justice & Welfare, International Relations, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Report/Index

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source · also reported by Magzter, India Today, IBG News, The Policy Edge, ETV Bharat, The Statesman

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Centre releases addl instalment of tax devolution of Rs. 1.09 trn to states

The Union Government released an additional Rs 1,09,019 crore in tax devolution to state governments on October 31, 2026. The funds were released ahead of the festive season to help states accelerate capital spending and meet welfare expenditures. This allocation is over and above the regular monthly tax devolution and marks the second additional instalment in FY 2026-27. Uttar Pradesh received the highest allocation of Rs 19,208 crore, followed by Bihar at Rs 10,845 crore and Madhya Pradesh at Rs 8,010 crore. Other major allocations included West Bengal at Rs 7,866 crore, Maharashtra at Rs 7,022 crore, and Rajasthan at Rs 6,460 crore. Tax devolution refers to distributing a share of central tax collections among state governments to finance their expenditure priorities. States are entitled to 41 per cent of the divisible pool of central taxes under the framework accepted from the 16th Finance Commission. The Union Budget 2026-27 has estimated total tax devolution to states at Rs 15.26 lakh crore for the financial year.

When: 31 October 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Government and State Governments · **Prelims:** Amount released: Rs 1,09,019 crore; State receiving the highest amount: Uttar Pradesh (Rs 19,208 crore); Share of central taxes devolved to states: 41 per cent

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides immediate liquidity to state governments to boost capital expenditure and infrastructure development.; Aids states in managing fiscal federalism and meeting seasonal welfare and developmental expenditure demands.*

Static — Tax devolution is the distribution of net proceeds of union taxes between the Centre and the states as recommended by the Finance Commission under Article 280 of the Constitution. The Finance Commission is a constitutional body set up every five years by the President of India to make recommendations on the distribution of financial resources. Article 275 of the Constitution provides for grants-in-aid to states out of the Consolidated Fund of India as determined by Parliament.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on devdiscourse.com · also reported by PIB, Business Standard

GS3 MAKE NOTES

IMF Lifts India’s Growth Forecast to 7%, US-Russia Diesel Deal Rattles Europe, and Japan Tops India’s FDI Charts

The IMF's October 2026 World Economic Outlook upgraded India's GDP growth forecast to 7% for both 2026 and 2027. The upgrade is driven by strong domestic demand, robust services activity, favorable demographics, and continued structural reforms. India remains the world's fastest-growing major economy, outperforming China at 4.5% and the US at 2.3%. Washington temporarily lifted sanctions on Russian diesel to ease US fuel prices, allowing over 300,000 tons of immediate shipments. The US-Russia diesel deal angered Ukraine and unsettled European allies who simultaneously approved new sanctions targeting Russia. Japan became India's largest source of foreign direct investment in Q1 FY2026-27 with inflows of $5.71 billion. The Japanese FDI surge was largely driven by Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group acquiring a 20% stake in Shriram Finance for about Rs. 39,620 crore. Other top FDI sources for the quarter included Singapore, Mauritius, the Netherlands, and the United States.

When: 2026-10-31 · **Where:** India, US, Russia, Europe, Japan · **Who:** IMF, Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group, Shriram Finance, Dr. Gulshan Sachdeva · **Prelims:** The IMF upgraded India's GDP growth forecast to 7% for 2026 and 2027.; China's growth forecast is 4.5% and the US growth forecast is 2.3% in the IMF report.; Japan's FDI inflows into India reached $5.71 billion in Q1 FY2026-27.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Cements India's position as the world's fastest-growing major economy amidst global headwinds.; Highlights policy divergences between Western allies regarding sanctions on Russian energy.*

Static — The International Monetary Fund (IMF) is an international organization headquartered in Washington, D.C., working to foster global monetary cooperation and secure financial stability. Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) represents ownership of a controlling stake in a business enterprise in one country by an entity based in another country. The World Economic Outlook is a survey by the IMF that is usually published twice a year in the spring and autumn.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India’s H1 FY27 Fiscal Deficit Reaches Rs. 7.14 Lakh Crore, Touching 42.1% of Annual Target

India's fiscal deficit for the first six months of the current financial year touched Rs 7.14 lakh crore. This amount constitutes 42.1 per cent of the budget estimate for the full financial year 2026-27. The Centre has budgeted a full-year fiscal deficit of Rs 16.96 lakh crore for FY27. Revenue receipts for the April-September period stood at Rs 17.57 lakh crore, which is 49.7 per cent of the budget estimate. Net tax revenue reached Rs 12.76 lakh crore, while non-tax revenue stood at Rs 4.81 lakh crore. Total government expenditure during this six-month period rose to Rs 25.5 lakh crore from Rs 23 lakh crore a year earlier. Capital expenditure on big-ticket projects in highways, rails, and ports increased to Rs 6.5 lakh crore. Subsidy expenditure rose to Rs 2.2 lakh crore due to higher prices of petroleum and fertilisers driven by the Middle East conflict. The government has lowered its fiscal deficit target to 4.3 per cent of GDP for the current financial year as part of fiscal consolidation.

When: 2026-10-30 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Central Government · **Prelims:** H1 FY27 fiscal deficit reached Rs 7.14 lakh crore.; Full-year budgeted fiscal deficit for FY27 is Rs 16.96 lakh crore.; Total government expenditure during April-September stood at Rs 25.5 lakh crore.

Why it matters — *Reflects the government's progress on its fiscal consolidation roadmap and budget targets.; Demonstrates sustained focus on capital expenditure for infrastructure creation despite global headwinds.*

Static — Fiscal deficit is the excess of total government expenditure over total receipts excluding borrowings in a financial year. Fiscal consolidation refers to the policies and practices undertaken by governments to reduce fiscal deficits and debt accumulation. Capital expenditure refers to funds used by the government to acquire, upgrade, and maintain physical assets like infrastructure.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

freepressjournal.in: read the source

Environment & Ecology

GS1 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Adi Tribe: Proposed 11,200 MW Siang Dam Raises Concerns Over Tribal Heritage

The planned 11,200 MW Siang Upper Multipurpose Project has sparked opposition due to fears of submerging farmland, settlements, and tribal cultural heritage. Tribal communities fear that alterations to the Siang River will dismantle the socio-cultural fabric and habitat of the indigenous Adi civilisation. At stake is balancing strategic mega-hydroelectric infrastructure in the frontier state against the protection of indigenous rights and delicate riverine ecosystems. The Adi community is a prominent indigenous tribe inhabiting Arunachal Pradesh, primarily located around Roing and Dambuk in the Lower Dibang Valley. Adi society operates under an organized, democratic traditional village council system known as the Kebang. Traditionally practicing the animist Donyi-Polo faith worshipping the sun and moon, Adis employ shamans called Miri, who can also be women. Economic livelihoods rely heavily on wet rice farming, shifting agriculture, fishing, hunting, and distinct cane and bamboo crafts. Major festivals celebrated by the tribe include Solung, Etor, and Aaran, accompanied by traditional dances such as Ponung and the Tapu war dance. Local groups and environmental defenders are seeking a review of the dam proposal to safeguard tribal lands and ancestral traditions.

When: 2026-10-31 · **Where:** Lower Dibang Valley, Arunachal Pradesh · **Who:** Adi tribal community and project planners · **Prelims:** The planned Siang Upper Multipurpose Project has a proposed capacity of 11,200 MW.; Kebang is the traditional democratic village council of the Adi community.; Donyi-Polo is the traditional animist religion centered on sun and moon worship.

Why it matters — *Highlights the persistent friction between large-scale renewable infrastructure goals and indigenous territorial rights.; Crucial for examining environmental clearances, tribal displacement, and cultural preservation under GS1 and GS3.*

Static — The Siang River originates as the Yarlung Tsangpo in Tibet before entering Arunachal Pradesh, where it merges with the Dibang and Lohit to form the Brahmaputra. Tribal areas in Arunachal Pradesh are governed under customary laws and community councils, with protection under the Sixth Schedule or special constitutional provisions. The Donyi-Polo indigenous faith represents nature and ancestral reverence, centered on Donyi (Sun) and Polo (Moon) as cosmic guiding forces.

Syllabus: GS1 / GS3: Environment & Ecology, Social Justice & Welfare, History, Art & Culture, Infrastructure & Energy

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

UNCCD COP17, Key Outcomes, India’s Initiatives, Progress

The 17th Conference of Parties to the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification took place in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, from August 17 to 28, 2026. The conference was held under the theme Restoring Land Restoring Hope and addressed land degradation affecting up to 40% of the world's land. UNCCD COP17 focused on shifting global efforts towards practical action, robust finance, rangeland management, and community-led restoration. The Rangelands Flagship Initiative was launched to mobilise about US$1.2 billion across 45 projects to restore degraded rangelands and support pastoralists. The Drought Resilience Investment Facility was launched with Luxembourg to mobilise up to US$400 million in public and private capital for drought resilience. Governments, funds, and companies announced a US$1.3 billion finance portfolio across 23 countries to treat land restoration as a key investment opportunity. India launched its first-ever Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems, recognizing them as distinct ecological entities rather than wasteland. India reported restoring approximately 21.76 million hectares of degraded and deforested land between 2011 and 2020 under its Bonn Challenge commitments.

When: 17 to 28 August 2026 · **Where:** Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia · **Who:** UNCCD Parties, Government of Mongolia, India, Luxembourg, IUCN · **Prelims:** COP17 of UNCCD was held in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, from 17 to 28 August 2026.; The Rangelands Flagship Initiative mobilizes about US$1.2 billion across 45 projects.; India launched its first-ever Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems at UNCCD COP17.

Why it matters — *Highlights the vital economic and ecological role of rangelands and pastoral communities globally.; Secures substantial financial portfolios and initiatives like the Rangelands Flagship Initiative to drive on-the-ground restoration.*

Static — The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification is a legally binding international framework established in 1994, entering into force in 1996 with 197 Parties. UNCCD is the sole legally binding global framework specifically created to address desertification, land degradation, and the effects of drought in drylands. The Conference of Parties acts as the primary decision-making body of the UNCCD, bringing together governments, scientists, civil society, and local stakeholders.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, International Relations, Disaster Management

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

ISRO's GSLV-F18 successfully places NVS-03 satellite into orbit to strengthen NavIC

ISRO successfully launched and placed the NVS-03 satellite into orbit using the GSLV launch vehicle. The successful launch restored the NavIC constellation back to its minimum operational configuration of four satellites. NavIC serves as a strategic national asset providing independent position, navigation, and timing services to India. ISRO Chairman V Narayanan announced that the launch campaign was completed in 47 days with four L40 strap-ons prepared in 37 days. The NVS-03 satellite carries an indigenous atomic clock alongside procured atomic clocks. The satellite incorporates the new L1 navigation signal in addition to existing L5 and S-band signals to expand capabilities. One of the newly carried indigenous atomic clocks was successfully placed in orbit. The mission ensures continuity of navigation services under the Indian Regional Navigation Satellite System.

When: 2026-10-31 · **Where:** India · **Who:** ISRO Chairman V Narayanan · **Prelims:** NVS-03 is part of ISRO's next-generation navigation satellite series.; The NavIC constellation requires a minimum operational configuration of four satellites.; NVS-03 carries both an indigenous atomic clock and procured atomic clocks.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Restores sovereign and independent navigation capabilities for India.; Demonstrates growing indigenous technological prowess in space missions and quick turnaround launch campaigns.*

Static — NavIC (Navigation with Indian Constellation) is India's regional satellite navigation system, formerly known as IRNSS. It is designed to provide accurate position information service to users in India as well as a region extending up to 1,500 km from its borders. The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) is the national space agency responsible for developing and launching the constellation.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology

aninews.in: read the source · also reported by Bhaskar English, Magzter, The Hindu, Civilsdaily, Hindustan Times, ThePrint, The Tribune

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Govt rolls out data-sharing framework to boost AI training while protecting privacy

The Union Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology launched a handbook to enable secure data sharing for artificial intelligence training. The launch aims to protect privacy, intellectual property, and institutional control while fostering AI development. The framework addresses concerns preventing institutions from sharing data by providing a techno-legal structure for purpose-bound collaboration. The Handbook on Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture for AI Training was unveiled in Bengaluru by MeitY secretary S Krishnan. The initiative was supported by the iSPIRT Foundation, with comments from figures like Principal Scientific Adviser Ajay Kumar Sood. The architecture combines contractual permissions, controlled computing environments, privacy-enhancing safeguards, and data provenance mechanisms. Under the DEPA approach, the AI model travels to the data rather than the data transferring to the model. Officials noted the framework aims to prevent India from becoming a digital colony and acts as a contribution to global science diplomacy.

When: 2026-10-31 · **Where:** Bengaluru · **Who:** S Krishnan, Ajay Kumar Sood, Sharad Sharma, Kris Gopalakrishnan · **Prelims:** The handbook was unveiled by MeitY secretary S Krishnan in Bengaluru.; The launch of the framework was supported by the iSPIRT Foundation.; Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India is Ajay Kumar Sood.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Unlocks large-scale datasets for domestic AI training without compromising institutional confidentiality.; Helps prevent foreign dependency and the risk of India becoming a digital colony.*

Static — Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a consent-based framework designed to give individuals and institutions secure control over their data sharing. The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology acts as the nodal central government ministry for policy matters relating to information technology and electronics. iSPIRT Foundation is a non-profit think tank that contributes to India's digital public infrastructure initiatives like UPI and Aadhaar-linked systems.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

DoT SIM Binding Rules 2027, Provisions, Restrictions, Impact

The Department of Telecommunications introduced new cybersecurity requirements under the Telecom Cyber Security Rules, 2024, known as the DoT SIM Binding Rules 2027. The rules mandate that messaging applications such as WhatsApp and Telegram must remain linked to the active SIM card of the user's registered Indian mobile number. The primary objective is to prevent cyber fraud, online scams, and the misuse of Indian mobile numbers by criminals operating domestically or internationally. If a user removes, replaces, or deactivates the registered SIM card, the messaging application may stop functioning until required SIM verification is completed. The government extended the compliance deadline to December 31, 2026, with the requirements officially taking effect from January 1, 2027. Initial rules requiring web-based sessions to log out every six hours were replaced with a risk-based logout system to terminate sessions upon detecting suspicious activity. Platforms named in original directions include WhatsApp, Telegram, Snapchat, Arattai, ShareShare, Josh, JioChat, and Signal, though compliance status varies. The rules create challenges for multiple-device users, international travellers, and individuals who frequently switch SIM cards or rely on Wi-Fi without their registered SIM.

When: December 31, 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Department of Telecommunications (DoT) · **Prelims:** Compliance deadline for DoT SIM Binding Rules is December 31, 2026.; Rules are introduced under the Telecom Cyber Security Rules, 2024.; Web and desktop logins will use a risk-based logout system.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Aims to curb cross-border cyber fraud and digital arrest scams targeting Indian citizens.; Enhances accountability and traceability of mobile numbers used on messaging applications.*

Static — The Department of Telecommunications functions under the Ministry of Communications, Government of India, responsible for formulating telecom policies and rules. The Telecom Cyber Security Rules provide the regulatory framework for securing India's telecommunications infrastructure against cyber threats and fraud. SIM binding technology ensures that a mobile application is strictly tethered to the physical subscriber identity module inserted in the device.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS EXERCISE QUICK READ

INAUGURAL BIMSTEC MARITIME SECURITY EXERCISE

India is hosting the BIMSTEC Maritime Security Exercise in Sri Vijaya Puram, Andaman and Nicobar Islands. The exercise stems from a key initiative announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the 6th BIMSTEC Summit in Thailand. The exercise commenced on the previous day and is scheduled to continue until the 3rd of the next month.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES QUICK READ

Dicharax tilariensis: Scientists Discover Tiny New Snail Species in Western Ghats

Researchers recently identified a new species of microscopic land snail named Dicharax tilariensis. The discovery was made in the Tilari region located in the Kolhapur district of Maharashtra. The species is currently known only from its discovery site near Swapnavel Point at an elevation of 700-800 metres. It inhabits the region's semi-evergreen forests and occupies microhabitats among forest litter, decaying organic matter, and moist soil.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

Punjab Cabinet approves service rules for separate cadre in BBMB

The Punjab Cabinet approved the Departmental Service Rules for a newly created separate cadre of employees to be posted in the BBMB. The decision aims to strengthen Punjab's representation in the Bhakra Beas Management Board and create employment opportunities for local youth. Under the Punjab Reorganisation Act, 1966, partner states send officers and employees on deputation to the BBMB.

tribuneindia.com: source

EDUCATION SCHEME QUICK READ

Last date for submission of applications under the National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship Scheme for academic year 2026-27 extended till November 15, 2026

The Union Education Ministry extended the application deadline for the National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship Scheme for academic year 2026-27 to November 15. The extension gives eligible students extra time to complete applications on the National Scholarship Portal and allows timely verification by authorities. As of October 30, 90,483 fresh applications and 1,99,531 renewal applications were submitted under the scheme.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Telangana introduces unified village development planning framework

The Panchayat Raj department in Telangana decided to introduce a systematic, convergent and scientific planning process called the Gram Panchayat Samagra Abhivruddhi Pranalika (GPSAP). The initiative was taken up following the directions of Panchayat Raj Minister Danasari Anasuya to prepare village-wise development plans for the next five years. The department claimed that this five-year perspective village planning framework is the first such initiative undertaken in the country.

The Hindu: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

CM Yogi Launches Skill And Employment Scheme

Chief minister Yogi Adityanath launched the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Skill Training and Employment Sector Development Scheme worth Rs 1725 crore at Lok Bhavan auditorium. The launch coincided with the 151st birth anniversary and National Unity Day of India's first deputy prime minister Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel. The scheme aims to transform Uttar Pradesh into a global manpower hub and equip youth with skills required by global industries.

hindustantimes.com: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Tripura minister Kishore Barman seeks Jal Shakti support to restore and develop Ramsar-listed Rudrasagar

Tripura higher education minister Kishore Barman sought the Jal Shakti ministry's help to restore and develop Rudrasagar Lake. The meeting took place with Union minister of state for Jal Shakti Dr Raj Bhushan Choudhary in Delhi. Rudrasagar Lake is Tripura's only Ramsar-designated Wetland of International Importance located in Sepahijala district. The minister presented proposals for a comprehensive rejuvenation plan to protect natural heritage and boost tourism.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

Punjab Cabinet approves 35 special NDPS courts to cut case backlog

The Punjab Cabinet approved the establishment of 35 exclusive special courts to handle cases under the NDPS Act. The decision aims to speed up trials, reduce trial delays, and cut down the massive backlog of drug cases. Punjab records about 20,000 NDPS cases and 27,000 arrests annually, leading to severe judicial delays.

indiatoday.in: source

ECONOMY SCHEME QUICK READ

Centre sets up panel to improve uptake of RELIEF scheme for exporters

The commerce ministry has established a six-member committee to improve fund utilisation and uptake of the RELIEF initiative for exporters. RELIEF is an initiative launched under the Rs 25,060-crore Export Promotion Mission to protect exporters from maritime disruptions and high costs. The intervention aims to shield exporters from soaring freight costs, increased insurance premiums, and maritime trade disruptions in Gulf and West Asian corridors.

Business Standard: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Bhimbandh Wildlife Sanctuary: Bihar Proposes Rs. 62.87 Crore Tourism Project Amid Legal Restrictions

The Bihar government has floated a tender for constructing sprawling tourism facilities inside the Bhimbandh Wildlife Sanctuary. This move comes despite statutory restrictions and a Supreme Court order restraining construction in protected areas. The proposed tourism project is valued at Rs. 62.87 crore. The sanctuary is located in the state of Bihar, south of the Ganges river, at the northern edge of the Chota Nagpur Plateau.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

India’s Social Security Coverage

The Ministry of Labour and Employment notified the constitution of the National Social Security Board for Unorganised Workers and the National Social Security Board for Gig and Platform Workers. The move aims to strengthen social security coverage for India's informal workforce, including delivery partners, app-based drivers and other gig professionals. The boards are established under the Code on Social Security, which came into force in November 2025.

PIB: source

HEALTH AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Assam to Set Up India’s First Public-Sector Proton Therapy Centre

The Assam government signed an agreement with Ion Beam Applications Particles of Belgium to set up India's first public proton beam therapy centre. The project aims to make advanced cancer treatment accessible and affordable, particularly for children, by attacking tumours with pinpoint precision while sparing healthy tissues.

theprint.in: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Piyush Goyal holds key bilateral meetings at WTO Ministerial Conference, pushes trade agreements and global cooperation

Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal held high-level bilateral meetings on the sidelines of the 14th WTO Ministerial Conference (MC-14). He met counterparts from Canada, the United Kingdom, New Zealand, and the European Union to accelerate trade agreements and partnerships. During talks with Canada's Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu, both discussed expediting the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) and diversifying cooperation.

ddnews.gov.in: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | SCHEME | QUICK READ

UN ends its Somalia political mission after three decades

The United Nations has ended its political mission in Somalia after three decades of engagement, with responsibilities transferred to Somali institutions and UN agencies. The closure follows a roadmap agreed between Somalia and the UN, marked by a farewell ceremony in Mogadishu attended by Deputy Prime Minister Saleh Ahmed Jama. The mission faced strained relations over the years, with Somali governments repeatedly accusing it of interference in domestic politics.

UN News: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

West Bengal to join Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY, becoming 36th state/UT to implement National Health Scheme

West Bengal is set to become the 36th State or Union Territory to implement the Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY scheme. The National Health Authority and the Government of West Bengal will sign an MoU at Vigyan Bhawan in New Delhi. The agreement aims to achieve universal health coverage and ensure equitable access to quality healthcare for citizens.

ddnews.gov.in: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

Ahead Of G20 Summit, US Ambassador Gor Teases ‘Exciting Outcomes’ From India-US Talks

US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor announced that the United States seeks to present exciting deliverables ahead of the G20 Summit in December. The statement followed US State Secretary Marco Rubio's recent visit to India, which heavily focused on commercial diplomacy and energy. Bilateral talks between India and the US have centered on negotiations for a proposed trade agreement and expanded energy cooperation.

msn.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

BRICS Sustainable Lifestyle Week From November 1: UGC Issues Advisory To Colleges

The University Grants Commission has asked all universities and colleges to participate in the BRICS Sustainable Lifestyle Week 2026 from November 1 to 7. The initiative is organized under Mission LiFE as part of India's BRICS Chairship in 2026 to promote environmentally responsible lifestyles. Higher Educational Institutions are required to conduct awareness programs, campus activities, and community initiatives centered around seven specific themes.

NDTV: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | QUICK READ

Nepal and Bhutan propose mountain climate agenda for COP31

Nepal and Bhutan jointly proposed a dedicated agenda item titled '1.5degC Warming in Mountains' for COP31 of the UNFCCC. The formal submission was addressed to the COP president, incoming COP president, and the executive secretary of the UNFCCC. The proposal warns that accelerated warming in regions like the Hindu Kush Himalaya threatens glaciers, water security, and livelihoods.

kathmandupost.com: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Gujarat expands post-matric scholarship for SC male students, approves Rs 18 crore scheme

The Gujarat state administration recently approved the Rs 18 crore funding to widen scholarship coverage. The Gujarat government has approved a Rs 18 crore scheme to expand post-matric scholarship benefits for SC male students.

ET Education: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

India hosts 8th BRICS Youth Energy Summit, focuses on youth-led energy innovation

India hosted the eighth BRICS Youth Energy Summit 2026 virtually on August 17 under its BRICS Chairship. The summit brought together over 100 young energy professionals, policymakers, academics, and international organisation representatives. The event was guided by the Energy Track theme " " (Energy for All), reflecting universal and affordable access. Discussions focused on three priority areas: energy security and sustainability, energy access and equity, and technology and innovation.

ddnews.gov.in: source

INTERNAL SECURITY QUICK READ

UP Approves Rs. 104.28 Crore Cybersecurity Project

The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet approved a cybersecurity project worth Rs. 104.28 crore to establish the UP Cyber Security Operations Centre. The initiative was triggered by the growing need to secure state government digital infrastructure against evolving cyber threats. At stake is the safety of government networks, sensitive public data, and digitally delivered citizen services across the state.

drishtiias.com: source

ECONOMY ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

CBDT Notifies New Rules for Merger of Registered Non-Profit Organisations — Form 112A Mandatory, 5-Year Restriction on Change of Objects and Transfer of Tax Liabilities

The Central Board of Direct Taxes issued the notification to regulate the restructuring of non-profit organisations. The CBDT has notified new rules for merging registered non-profit organisations, mandating Form 112A, imposing a five-year restriction on object changes, and clarifying the transfer of tax liabilities.

A2Z Taxcorp LLP: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

How India Went From The Wetland Watchlist To 101 Ramsar Sites

The milestone of reaching 101 Ramsar sites puts India's recent wetland conservation achievements in the news. India has successfully expanded its protected wetland network to 101 designated Ramsar sites, marking a significant milestone in environmental conservation.

Swarajya: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED QUICK READ

Seoni Jumbo Custard Apple Receives GI Tag

The Seoni Jumbo Custard Apple recently received its official GI tag recognition. The Seoni Jumbo Custard Apple has been officially granted the Geographical Indication (GI) tag, recognizing its unique regional heritage.

GK Today: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 GS3 Suboptimal Outcomes Social Security Boards for Unorganised, Gig and Platform Workers

The Union Labour Ministry has constituted the National Social Security Boards for Unorganised Workers and Gig and Platform Workers under the Code on Social Security. These Boards aim to strengthen social protection for vulnerable workers through welfare schemes, institutional oversight, and recommended measures. The central concern is that their centralised composition and representation gaps raise issues about inclusive decision-making and cooperative federalism.

The Hindu

GS2 Justice Sanjay Kishan Kaul on his memoir 'Without Fear or Favour 'and the executive's growing influence over the collegium system

The discussion stems from the release of his memoir titled Without Fear or Favour. Former Supreme Court judge Justice Sanjay Kishan Kaul discusses executive influence on the collegium system and appointment delays in his memoir. The former Supreme Court judge on delays in clearing collegium recommendations and the need for reform

The Hindu

GS3 How AI is transforming U.S. military industrial complex

It appeared as an opinion piece in The Hindu discussing modern technological shifts in global defense infrastructure. An editorial explaining how the core of the US military industrial complex has shifted from physical factories to servers due to software-defined warfare and venture capital logic. The core of the MIC has shifted from the factory to the server due to the arithmetic of cost-imposition, the venture-velocity logic of capital, and the architectural revolution of software-defined warfare

The Hindu

GS2 Pet policy can fix enforcement gaps

The Mangaluru City Corporation decided to impose fines of Rs 1,000 to Rs 5,000 on pet owners failing to clean up dog excreta in public places. The guidelines also mandate vaccination, sterilisation, and leashing of pets, alongside warning against the abandonment of animals. Pet waste causes friction in public and residential areas, reflecting a disregard for civic responsibility and public cleanliness. The Karnataka High Court directed the erstwhile BBMP in November 2024 to amend bye-laws for higher penalties against pet fouling.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Economic Policy Uncertainty, Industry-level Dynamics and Resource Use Intensity in Indian Manufacturing

The editorial appears in the Economic and Political Weekly, examining the intersection of macroeconomic policy, industrial behavior, and resource economics. An editorial analyzing how economic policy uncertainty impacts industry-level dynamics and resource use intensity within the Indian manufacturing sector.

EPW

GS2 The Collegium cannot remain a closed-door affair

The ongoing discourse regarding the need for openness and reform in the appointment of judges. An editorial discussing the need for transparency and reform in the judiciary's Collegium appointment system. Collegium reform: Towards transparency

Deccan Herald

GS2 A UN protection force must be urgently deployed to Palestine

The author argues that an international protection force must be urgently deployed to Palestine to prevent ongoing violence and protect civilian life. Israeli policies in the occupied West Bank, East Jerusalem, and Gaza have accelerated since October 2023, destroying housing, healthcare, education, and livelihoods. In Gaza, roughly 81 percent of structures have been destroyed, leaving 1.9 million people displaced, while only 19 of 36 hospitals remain partially functional.

Al Jazeera

GS3 Ramalinga Raju who went for a ride on a tiger and stopped smiling thereafter

The editorial reflects on the historical corporate scandal involving Satyam Computer Services and its founder Ramalinga Raju. The article revisits the rise and fall of Ramalinga Raju, who built Satyam Computer Services before confessing to a massive corporate accounting fraud. Ramalinga Raju rode India’s IT boom to the top, building Satyam into a leading software exporter. Then a confession of cooked books exposed one of the country’s biggest corporate frauds.

Mint

GS1 The Return of Economic Geography

The text appeared as an editorial in Economic and Political Weekly (EPW) on October 31, 2026. The editorial discusses the renewed importance of economic geography in shaping modern global trade, industrial policy, and national security strategies.

EPW

GS2 Bombay High Court’s two faces of justice

The editorial was triggered by two contrasting rulings issued by the Bombay High Court within the same week. An editorial critique of the Bombay High Court's contrasting judicial approaches towards ordinary citizens and corporate accountability. In one week, the court blamed 42 per cent of Mumbai’s population for the city’s filth while staying an investigation into a CEO whose factory killed two workers, reiterating the message of Bhopal: Indian lives count for less than foreign investment.

Frontline

GS3 Best of Opinion: From closing window to overshoot, climate action retreats

The publication compiled a summary of recent expert opinion pieces addressing pressing global challenges. Opinion columns review global issues such as climate overshoot, the environmental costs of artificial intelligence, political shifts in Israel, and economic crises in China and the US. Today's columns examine climate overshoot and AI's environmental costs, Netanyahu's electoral position in Israel, US midterm implications for oil prices and China's property crisis

Business Standard

GS3 When someone does your push-ups, can you feel your muscles flex?

The accusation made by Anthropic against Alibaba regarding intellectual property theft put the issue in the news. Anthropic has accused Alibaba of stealing its intellectual property and called this industrial espionage. The company's business model involves charging creators who contributed to its training data. This raises questions about the implications of artificial intelligence on independent thinking and creativity. The author emphasizes the importance of personal struggle in the thinking process.

Economic Times

GS3 Festive pollution : Diwali joy must not come at health’s cost

The Supreme Court observed that Diwali is a festival of lights and not gunpowder, emphasizing that celebrations should not come at the cost of public health. Unchecked use of conventional firecrackers adds severe toxicity to an already existing mix of vehicular emissions, construction dust, industrial pollution, and stubble burning. Vulnerable groups such as children, the elderly, and individuals with pre-existing respiratory ailments bear a disproportionate burden of these harmful fumes.

tribuneindia.com

GS3 Spectre of Carbon Tax on Indian Manufacturing

Growing global climate regulations and discussions around carbon taxation mechanisms affecting international trade. An editorial analyzing the impact and challenges of potential carbon taxes and border adjustments on Indian manufacturing.

EPW

GS2 Why this political scientist argued for restructuring centre-state financial relations in 1980s

Federal systems inherently face conflicts that require effective management through elite consensus on ground rules for decision-making and resource allocation. The operation style of federal institutions is crucial for managing these conflicts successfully in any federal polity. In India, centre-state relations face severe strain because elite consensus is low and federal institutions often fail to represent states legitimate demands. This strain has led to organised demands for structural changes in Indian federalism, particularly regarding centre-state financial relations.

ThePrint

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

What are the new questions in 2027 Census, and how are enumerators being trained? Explained Uttar Pradesh and three other poll-bound states are preparing to launch the second phase of Census 2027 on December 1. The upcoming second phase of Census 2027 will feature 40 detailed questions covering caste, religion, Aadhaar access, and parents' details, with about 34 lakh enumerators currently undergoing digital training.

The Hindu

How significant is the TVK-led regime's move to hold Social Justice Survey? Concerns expressed by parties and stakeholders over the open column feature for stating caste in the upcoming Census February next year. An explainer on the significance of the TVK-led regime's move to conduct a Social Justice Survey amidst concerns over census caste data collection methods.

The Hindu

Elderly Care in India – Need & Challenges – Explained Pointwise India is undergoing a significant demographic transition with a steadily increasing proportion of its population entering old age. India currently has more than 150 million elderly people, which is about 10 percent of the total population, making it the second-largest elderly population globally.

ForumIAS

Can India and China Coexist Peacefully? India and China remain in managed coexistence without active war, but border tensions and strategic distrust continue to limit normal relations. The unresolved boundary dispute, military competition, and differing geopolitical interests raise questions about peaceful coexistence between the two civilisations.

ForumIAS

Explained: The latest World Bank report on India and decline in extreme poverty between 2011 and 2023 Between 2011 and 2023, India lifted an estimated 49.6 crore people out of poverty according to the World Bank report. Extreme poverty measured at USD 3 per day declined sharply from 27.1 percent to 2.6 percent over this twelve-year period.

msn.com

How Xi Jinping's sweeping military purge echoed at a top Chinese leaders' meeting The developments emerged as a significant topic of discussion and observation surrounding a top Chinese leaders' meeting. An explainer on how Xi Jinping's sweeping military purge resonated during a high-level meeting of Chinese leaders.

Indian Express

Explained: Why India's rejection of a TB drug patent matters for patients The Indian Patent Office denied a US-based organization's patent application for the BPaL regimen, which is a combination therapy for drug-resistant tuberculosis. The rejection was based on Indian patent law criteria and aims to prevent monopolies from restricting patient access to essential medicines.

msn.com

GSLV-F18 places navigation satellite NVS-03 into orbit | What is NavIC? ISRO successfully launched the NVS-03 navigation satellite aboard a GSLV rocket from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota. The launch was conducted to augment India's regional satellite navigation system and restore NavIC to its minimum operational configuration of four satellites.

news.abplive.com

Explained | Drones, fog and infiltration: How India is strengthening J&K's LoC security grid The evolving security challenges along the border have put the focus on upgrading the Line of Control security grid. This explainer details the measures taken by India to reinforce the security grid along the Line of Control in Jammu and Kashmir to counter drones, fog, and infiltration.

Deccan Herald

Why some Delhi High Court judges are less likely to grant bail than others The report examines statistical variations in judicial decision-making regarding personal liberty and bail. An analysis explores how bail grant rates differ among various judges sitting in the Delhi High Court.

Indian Express

On Vallabhbhai Patel's birth anniversary, a historian explains how he became 'Sardar' It was published on Vallabhbhai Patel's birth anniversary. An explainer detailing the historical circumstances and events through which Vallabhbhai Patel came to be known by the title Sardar.
Indian Express

EXPLAINED | Who Gets a Seat at the G20? The Power Struggle Behind the Missing Photo The topic is in the news due to discussions surrounding international diplomatic optics and representation at global summits. An explainer on the membership criteria, power struggles, and diplomatic nuances behind G20 summit groupings and photos.
Open Magazine

Despite flood devastation, how Nepal continued exporting power to India Recent flood devastation in Nepal raised questions about the continuity of its cross-border power supply to India. An explainer detailing how Nepal maintained its electricity exports to India despite severe disruptions caused by floods.
Indian Express

Why investors are worried despite Alphabet's 25% revenue growth and Google Cloud's revenue more than doubling The report highlights investor anxiety amid Alphabet's recent financial results showing massive investments in AI infrastructure. Alphabet achieved strong revenue growth and doubling cloud revenue, but heavy capital expenditure on artificial intelligence infrastructure and uncertainty over AI-powered search profitability have triggered investor concerns.
The Hindu

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Odisha Cabinet approves new rules for Shree Jagannath Temple land management (History, Art & Culture) DD News
- Glacial Lake Outburst Flood (GLOF), Meaning, Causes, Examples in India (Disaster Management) Vajiram & Ravi
- Maharashtra earmarks 5% district funds for fodder schemes amid drought, bans interstate movement (Agriculture & Allied) BusinessLine
- Noyyal River (Environment & Ecology) ForumIAS
- Mizoram Gets Approval for New Road Works under PMGSY-IV to Strengthen Rural Connectivity (Governance & Policy) PIB
- Delhi Records Lowest Average AQI for October in the Last Eight Years at 166 (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- Sri Lanka's Tamil Political Blocs Agree Joint Protest Against Terrorism Act (International Relations) Sri Lanka Guardian
- UN makes nine recommendations on proposed State Protection from Terrorism Act (International Relations) Sri Lanka Mirror
- India-China ties moving in positive direction; PM Modi to hold bilateral talks with world leaders at BRICS: MEA (International Relations) DD News
- Gujarat High Court restores ban on non-veg eateries near Somnath Temple hours after single-judge lifts ban (Polity & Constitution) Bar & Bench
- Keralam's Malappuram Rolls Out Centre's SMILE Scheme To Help People Quit Begging (Social Justice & Welfare) Outlook India
- Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh calls for joint efforts to build self-reliant Panchayats; MoU signed for EV charging stations (Governance & Policy) www.indiagazette.com
- NGT Slams Bhopal Municipal Corporation Over Incomplete Report On 50 Illegal Plastic Recycling Units, Demands (Environment & Ecology) Free Press Journal
- Jaishankar Holds Bilateral Meetings with EU, Germany, Brazil, Mexico, Canada and Argentina on G20 Sidelines (International Relations) DD India
- Exercise AUSTRAHIND: India, Australia troops demonstrate joint operational capabilities (Defence) IANS LIVE
- Climate COP31 Guterres (Environment & Ecology) WV News
- Unlicensed Maharashtra Moneylenders Cannot Enforce Promissory Note Loans: SC [Read Judgment] (Polity & Constitution) LawStreet Journal
- Ground Report: Thousands Relocated In Bengal After Lake Burst In Bhutan (Disaster Management) NDTV
- 'Consider notices on voter deletions when alerted': Supreme Court tells Election Commission (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- New Zealand Parliament clears FTA with India (International Relations) DD News
- Centre clears project worth Rs 40,000 crore for 8 next-gen stealth warships (Defence) Indian Express
- Venezuela: Location, Geography, Oil Reserves & Significance (Geography) Insights on India
- Health Ministry tightens drug approval norms, introduces debarment for fake data submissions (Health) DD News
- Society that accepts unverified claims and fears questions is vulnerable to authoritarianism: Justice Bhuyan (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Supreme Court Declares Karnataka's 2022 Law on KAS Recruitment Unconstitutional (Polity & Constitution) GKToday
- RBI revises capital adequacy norms for banks (Economy) DD News
- Delhi-NCR pollution: CAQM orders construction ban, 50% work-from-home from November 5 to 20 (Environment & Ecology) The Economic Times
- Iran says multiple oil tankers strike mines, catch fire in Strait of Hormuz (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- India's exports rise 4.22% to $860.09 billion in FY26; imports grow faster, widening trade deficit (Economy) DD News

- Police Officer Accused Of Corruption Can't Claim Parity With Layman : Supreme Court Cancels Anticipatory... (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- India steps up deep-sea mining push to secure critical minerals and strengthen Blue Economy (Economy) DD News
- Naxal-free India: How an integrated strategy transformed India’s fight against Left-Wing Extremism (Internal Security) DD News
- Rajnath Singh unveils ‘RAKSHA’ document outlining India’s 10-year defence diplomacy roadmap (Defence) DD News
- India’s ethanol transition: Can grain-based feedstocks fill the gap left by sugar? (Economy) BusinessLine
- Pendency of appeal no ground to free those convicted in heinous crimes: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Deccan Herald
- Can transwomen access women’s shelters, washrooms? Plea brings gender vs sex debate to SC (Polity & Constitution) ThePrint
- PM Modi approves northern bullet train corridor linking Delhi to Guwahati via Siliguri (Infrastructure & Energy) GKToday
- India’s first fusion power company takes key steps (Science & Technology) The Hindu
- India Achieves Major Milestone in Fight Against Naxalism After Six Decades (Internal Security) www.nationpathindia.com
- 12 Years of PMJDY: 59.09 Crore Accounts Opened, Deposits Reach Rs. 3.17 Lakh Crore (Economy) DD News
- First import container arrives at Vizhinjam (Infrastructure & Energy) The Hindu
- NCAP 2026 (Environment & Ecology) Down To Earth
- FATF Steps Up Action on Virtual-Asset Crime and Scam Compounds (Economy) GKToday

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 16 must-know, 24 Prelims facts, 43 in the news, 15 editorials, 14 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — International Relations (9), Governance & Policy (8), Economy (7), Environment & Ecology (7), Science & Technology (3), Polity & Constitution (1), Education (1), Health (1), Social Justice & Welfare (1), Internal Security (1), Agriculture & Allied (1). **Nothing today in —** Infrastructure & Energy, Defence, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 4 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 1 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 2 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 2

Full text — 46 of 69 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — ddnews.gov.in 8, The Hindu 7, Vajiram & Ravi 6, Indian Express 4, Economic Times 3, PIB 3, msn.com 3, Deccan Herald 3, EPW 3, Hindustan Times 2, tribuneindia.com 2, Business Standard 2, ForumIAS 2, aninews.in 1

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